

The Idea of a Base — Answers

Final answers with a one-line reason. For full methods, see the worked examples in the notes.

Objective

- Q1** (b) **powers of n.** Each landmark is the previous one $\times n$.
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- Q2** (b) **base-10.** Its landmark numbers are 1, 10, 100, 1000...
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- Q3** **1033.** $143 = 1 \times 125 + 0 \times 25 + 3 \times 5 + 3 \times 1$.
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- Q4** (a) **143.** $1 \times 125 + 0 \times 25 + 3 \times 5 + 3$.
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- Q5** **True.** The base tells you how many of one landmark make the next.
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- Q6** (a) **Both true, R explains A.** $100 = 4 \times 25 + 0 \times 5 + 0 = 400$ in base 5.
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Short answer

- Q7** **2244 (base 5).** $324 = 2 \times 125 + 2 \times 25 + 4 \times 5 + 4$.
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- Q8** **288.** $2 \times 125 + 1 \times 25 + 2 \times 5 + 3 = 250 + 25 + 10 + 3$.
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- Q9** **1, 5, 25, 125, 625, 3125.** (Powers of 5.)
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Long answer

- Q10** (i) **400 in base 5** (ii) **1210 in base 4.** $100 = 4 \times 25$ (base 5); $100 = 1 \times 64 + 2 \times 16 + 1 \times 4 + 0$ (base 4).
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- Q11** **16 = 100 in base 4.** 16 is exactly the landmark number $4^2 = 16$, so it is $1 \times 16 + 0 \times 4 + 0 \times 1$.
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- Q12** **Because landmark numbers are powers, their product is another landmark number** (e.g. $10^2 \times 10^3 = 10^5$). The Roman system has irregular landmark sizes, so multiplication there is much harder.
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Total: 21 marks.